

UNNAMED WORLD

When the sun sets, the whole world changes; demons stalk the darkness.

GRAVENHOLD · 16 MAY 2026

THE WORLD

BLEAK, END OF THE WORLD DEMON WAR

For centuries humanity has endured a losing war against demons that appear at night. Roads between settlements have diminished, and entire kingdoms have vanished. The world fell slowly, not due to a single battle but through the relentless assault of demons. Humans have survived only because they have not lost completely yet. The demon hierarchy is diverse, with different orders and types, ranging from lesser Wretches to powerful Exalted demons who warp reality and corrupt minds.

Demons are unnatural entities born from rot, despair, hatred, and corruption. They are dispatched by humanity using sacred warded circles necessary to truly banish them.

WHAT YOU KNOW

DEMON WAR

ESTABLISHED

Humanity is losing a centuries-long war against demons. The demons appear at night and vanish by day, attacking settlements and defeating defenders.

DEMON HIERARCHY

ESTABLISHED

There are multiple tiers of demons: Wretches are the smallest formed creatures that roam at night; Thralls are mortals who have joined the demons. True demons are intelligent, strategic, and include higher-tier entities like Exalted demons that can corrupt large areas.

WARDED CIRCLES

ESTABLISHED

Warded circles are a crucial defense against demons. They make demons corporeal and are needed for a true destruction of major demons. They are not magic in a conventional sense but are physical structures anyone can create.

ZOLKATHAR

RUMORED

Known as the Black Sovereign, the Lord Beneath the Night, and the Rotten King. If Zolkathar fully rises, humanity will not survive the century.

FACTIONS & POWERS

IRON WATCH

ALLY

Coordinates nightly defenses in Gravenhold.
Essential for the city's defense against nighttime demonic attacks.

CIRCLE WARDENS

ALLY

Prepare rituals that keep the darkness at bay.
Experts in maintaining warded circles and crucial to humanity's survival.

KNOWN LOCATIONS

GRAVENHOLD

Last great fortress city among stone ridges and valleys, with blackened walls from siege and rebuilt districts.
Starting point of the campaign, central to human survival.

VIGIL SPIRE

Military and ritual heart of Gravenhold.
Center for planning defenses and maintaining warded circles.

CREATING YOUR CHARACTER

Players are recognized figures such as warriors, hunters, scholars or notable survivors called to Gravenhold at humanity's darkest hour.

RECOMMENDED CLASSES

WARRIOR Needed for defending against demonic onslaughts.

CLERIC Can provide blessings and rituals to protect against demons.

RECOMMENDED BACKGROUNDS

SOLDIER Familiar with warfare and defense in a demon war setting.

SCHOLAR Valuable knowledge of demons and warded circles.

THEMES & MOTIVATIONS

DEFENSE OF HUMANITY

ENDURANCE AGAINST A LOSING WAR

EXPLORATION OF DESPAIR AND HOPE

- Campaign is not suited for characters without a strong motivation to fight demons.
- Impulsive behavior may lead to severe consequences given demonic threats.

HOW WE PLAY

Warded Circles

CUSTOM MECHANIC

Physical structures that make true demons and higher corporeal, necessary for fully banishing them.

Daytime Travel

HOUSE RULE

All travel should occur during the day to avoid nighttime demonic attacks.

Side Quest System

CUSTOM MECHANIC

A side quest system via Discord where players solve clues to gain rewards between sessions.